JUNIOR SCHOOL LEARNING HUB

GRADE 9
CREATIVE ARTS AND SPORTS

DETAILED FULL-YEAR LEARNER NOTES | TERMS 1, 2 AND 3

CBC-aligned teacher-prepared learning resource

These notes support learning through making, performing, observing, practising, reflecting and appreciating creative and physical activities. They are organised as a study resource; the teacher should sequence activities according to the current KICD Grade 9 design, available facilities and the school's approved scheme of work.

How to use these notes

- Read the explanations and study the vocabulary before attempting each practical task.
- Keep a portfolio containing sketches, design plans, lyrics or scripts written by you, practice logs, photographs of permitted work and reflection notes.
- Practise safely. Use tools, equipment, spaces and materials only after instructions and risk checks.
- Give constructive feedback: describe what you notice, explain what works and suggest one achievable improvement.
- Sports activities should be adapted to learners' abilities, health needs, available space and equipment. Participation, safety and fair play matter more than winning.

Learning area overview

Creative Arts and Sports develops creativity, communication, cultural understanding, physical competence, collaboration, self-discipline and healthy living. Learners explore visual expression, music, drama and movement, and physical activity. The strands and sub-strands below are presented as an integrated study guide; confirm exact sub-strand wording and lesson allocation against the school's copy of the KICD Grade 9 Curriculum Design.

Core vocabulary

Term	Meaning
Aesthetics	The study and appreciation of beauty, meaning and artistic experience.
Composition	The planned arrangement of elements in an artwork or performance.
Medium	The material or method used to make an artwork, such as pencil, paint, clay or digital tools.
Technique	A particular way of carrying out an artistic or sporting action.

Rhythm	The organised pattern of sounds and silences in time.
Melody	A sequence of pitches perceived as a musical line.
Tempo	The speed of music or movement.
Dynamics	The variation in loudness or intensity.
Choreography	The planned arrangement of movements in a dance.
Improvisation	Creating or performing spontaneously within an agreed context.
Fitness	The capacity to perform daily and physical activities effectively.
Fair play	Respecting rules, opponents, officials and teammates.

PART A: VISUAL ARTS

Visual art communicates ideas, feelings, experiences and cultural knowledge through images and objects. An artist observes carefully, plans, experiments with materials, makes choices and evaluates the result.

1. Elements of art

The elements are the basic visual building blocks used by artists. A line may be straight, curved, thick, thin, broken or expressive. Shape is a two-dimensional enclosed area; form is three-dimensional and has volume. Colour can attract attention, create mood and communicate meaning. Texture is the actual or implied surface quality. Space refers to the area around, between and within forms. Value describes how light or dark a tone appears.

Artists combine elements deliberately. A dark line against a pale background creates contrast. Repeated shapes can create pattern. Large forms may dominate a composition while smaller forms provide supporting detail.

- Line: outline, contour, hatching, cross-hatching and expressive mark-making.
- Shape: geometric shapes such as circles and squares; organic shapes found in nature.
- Form: cube, sphere, cylinder, cone and irregular three-dimensional forms.
- Colour: primary, secondary, warm, cool, complementary and analogous relationships.
- Texture: rough, smooth, soft, hard, glossy or rough-looking marks.
- Space: foreground, middle ground, background, positive and negative space.
- Value: gradual shading from highlights to mid-tones and dark shadows.

2. Principles of design and composition

Principles describe how elements are organised. Balance may be symmetrical, asymmetrical or radial. Contrast creates difference and emphasis. Unity makes the parts feel related, while variety prevents monotony. Rhythm and repetition guide the viewer's eye. Proportion concerns the size relationships between parts. Emphasis establishes a focal point.

A composition is stronger when the artist decides what the viewer should notice first, second and last. The focal point may be created through size, colour, placement, detail or contrast.

- Before making an artwork, identify its purpose, audience and message.
- Make small thumbnail sketches to test different arrangements.
- Use a clear focal point and avoid placing every object at equal visual importance.
- Check margins, spacing, overlap and the relationship between foreground and background.

3. Drawing, observation and shading

Observational drawing means drawing from direct looking rather than relying only on memory. Begin by identifying the overall shape and proportions. Compare heights and widths, notice angles, and use simple construction lines before adding details.

Shading describes form. Hatching uses parallel lines; cross-hatching layers intersecting lines; stippling uses dots; blending creates gradual transitions. A consistent light source helps shadows appear believable.

- Exercise: arrange a cup, bottle and fruit. Sketch their basic shapes lightly.
- Measure relative proportions by comparing one object's height with another.
- Identify the light source; shade the darkest areas gradually.
- Add cast shadows on the surface and check that objects appear to rest on it.
- Review the drawing for proportion, tonal range, texture and neatness.

4. Colour theory and painting

Pigments are materials that give paint its colour. A colour wheel helps show relationships. In the traditional RYB art model, red, yellow and blue are commonly taught as primary colours; mixing two primaries produces secondary colours such as orange, green and violet. Mixing a primary with a neighbouring secondary produces an intermediate colour.

Warm colours such as reds, oranges and yellows can feel energetic or visually advance. Cool colours such as blues and greens can feel calm or recede. Complementary colours sit opposite one another on the colour wheel and create strong contrast when placed together.

- Mix small test samples before applying colour to the final work.
- Use water or medium in controlled amounts according to the paint type.
- Apply lighter areas and larger colour masses before fine details.
- Allow layers to dry when the technique requires it.
- Clean brushes and store materials responsibly; never pour paint or chemicals into drains unless product guidance permits.

5. Pattern, printmaking and design

A pattern is created by repeating or alternating motifs. A motif is a repeated unit such as a leaf, geometric shape, symbol or line arrangement. Pattern can be regular, alternating, radial or random. Repetition creates unity; variation can create interest.

Printmaking transfers an image from a prepared surface to another material. Simple school methods may include safe relief printing with foam, card or other approved materials. The design is planned, transferred, prepared, inked and printed.

- Create a motif inspired by plants, architecture or locally observed patterns without copying sacred or restricted cultural designs inappropriately.
- Repeat the motif in a grid, border or radial arrangement.

- Test print on scrap paper before making the final print.
- Label the design with its inspiration, materials, process and intended audience.

6. Three-dimensional art and sculpture

Sculpture occupies space and can be viewed from different directions. It may be modelled by adding material, carved by removing material, assembled from separate components or constructed from found/reused materials.

Consider stability, balance, proportion, texture and the viewer's viewpoint. A sculpture should be safely supported and should not have sharp or unstable parts.

- Plan the front, side and top views where useful.
- Choose a suitable material such as clay, paper, cardboard, wire with safe ends or clean reused packaging.
- Build a stable base and join components securely.
- Finish surfaces carefully and explain the meaning of the finished form.

7. Art appreciation, critique and portfolio

Appreciation means looking carefully, describing, interpreting and evaluating an artwork. Begin with what is visible before making claims about the artist's intention. A useful critique asks: What do I see? How is it organised? What might it communicate? What evidence supports my interpretation? What could be improved?

A portfolio records development rather than only displaying finished work. Include planning sketches, experiments, drafts, final pieces and reflections.

- Describe observable elements without insulting the artist.
- Explain how a design choice affects meaning or mood.
- Compare two works using evidence such as colour, line, composition and material.
- Reflect on one strength, one challenge and one next step.

PART B: MUSIC

Music is organised sound. Learners develop listening, performance, composition and appreciation skills. Music can preserve history, express identity, entertain, educate and bring communities together.

8. Sound, pitch, rhythm and melody

Sound is produced by vibration and travels through a medium. Pitch describes how high or low a sound is; it is related to frequency. Loudness is related to the amplitude of vibration. Duration is how long a sound lasts, while timbre is the quality that distinguishes one sound source from another.

Rhythm is the arrangement of sounds and silences in time. A steady beat provides a pulse. Tempo describes the speed of the beat. Melody is a sequence of pitches that forms a recognisable musical idea.

- Clap a steady pulse while a partner speaks or performs a rhythm.
- Use ta, ti-ti and rest syllables, or another notation system taught by the teacher, to represent long and short sounds.
- Listen for repeated rhythmic patterns and identify changes in tempo.
- Sing or play a short melody accurately, maintaining pitch and pulse.

9. Musical notation and performance skills

Notation is a way of recording music so that performers can interpret it. Staff notation uses five lines and four spaces. Clefs identify pitch reference points. Notes show pitch and duration; rests show silence. Time signatures indicate how beats are grouped in a measure. Learners should use the notation system prescribed in class.

Good performance requires preparation, posture, breathing, accurate timing, attentive listening and confidence. In ensemble work, performers must listen to one another and follow agreed cues.

- Warm up the voice gently; avoid shouting or forcing high notes.
- Practise difficult phrases slowly before increasing the tempo.
- Mark entrances, rests, repeated sections and ending cues.
- Rehearse in small groups, then perform together.
- Give feedback on accuracy, expression, balance and teamwork.

10. Musical instruments and sound production

Instruments can be grouped by how they produce sound. Percussion instruments are struck, shaken or scraped. String instruments produce sound through vibrating strings. Wind instruments use vibrating air columns or reeds. Electronic instruments generate or modify sound electronically.

An instrument should be handled according to its construction. Learners should not force keys, stretch strings excessively or share mouthpieces without appropriate hygiene procedures.

- Identify the sound-producing part of an instrument.
- Compare the timbre of two instruments playing the same rhythm.
- Explore safe body percussion using claps, taps and stamps.
- Make a simple instrument from clean reusable materials only when the teacher has checked safety.

11. Composition, improvisation and arrangement

Composition is the creation of an original musical piece. A short composition may begin with a rhythmic motif, a melodic phrase or a repeated pattern. A motif can be repeated, varied, extended or contrasted.

Improvisation involves creating music spontaneously. It still benefits from boundaries such as a key, pulse, scale, rhythm pattern or turn-taking rule. Arrangement adapts music for a particular group of performers or instruments.

- Choose a short theme such as friendship, environment or school life.
- Create a four- or eight-beat rhythm pattern and repeat it consistently.
- Add a simple melodic idea or spoken/sung response.
- Organise an introduction, main section and ending.
- Perform, record observations and revise the piece.

12. Listening, musical culture and appreciation

Active listening means focusing on musical features rather than hearing sound in the background. Listen for tempo, dynamics, rhythm, melody, texture, instruments, structure and mood. Support interpretations with evidence from what is heard.

Kenya has diverse musical traditions associated with communities, occasions, languages and histories. Music may accompany ceremonies, work, storytelling, worship, celebration and social commentary. No

single performance represents an entire community. Ask permission before recording people or using culturally sensitive material.

- Listen to contrasting Kenyan and other musical examples selected by the teacher.
- Identify instruments, language, performance setting and musical features where known.
- Discuss the social function of the music without stereotyping a community.
- Compare similarities and differences respectfully.
- Credit performers, composers and sources when presenting recorded material.

PART C: DRAMA, THEATRE AND DANCE

Drama uses role, action, voice, movement and space to explore human experiences. Dance communicates through organised body movement, rhythm, space and energy. Both require imagination, discipline, collaboration and respect.

13. Voice, movement and expression

Voice communicates through volume, pace, pitch, tone, pause and clarity. Projection means making the voice audible without shouting. Articulation is the clear formation of speech sounds. Movement includes posture, gesture, facial expression, direction, levels and pace.

Performers should warm up safely, use space responsibly and avoid movements that cause pain or risk injury.

- Practise breathing and speaking a short passage clearly.
- Repeat the same line using different emotions and discuss how voice changes meaning.
- Use still images or tableaux to communicate a situation without words.
- Explore high, middle and low body levels while maintaining safe balance.

14. Character, role-play and improvisation

A character is a person or role represented in a performance. A performer develops a character by considering background, objectives, relationships, feelings and choices. Role-play allows learners to explore situations from different perspectives.

Improvisation is spontaneous creation. It works best when participants accept offers, listen, contribute relevant ideas and maintain agreed boundaries. A scene should have a clear situation, conflict or problem, development and resolution.

- Create a short scene about solving a disagreement at school.
- Assign roles and identify what each character wants.
- Use dialogue, gesture and facial expression to reveal relationships.
- Keep the scene respectful and avoid humiliating or stereotyping others.
- Reflect on how the scene's choices affected its outcome.

15. Script, staging and theatre roles

A script may include dialogue, stage directions, setting, characters and sequence of events. A scene is a unit of dramatic action. Stage directions guide movement, sound, lighting or expression.

Theatre involves more than actors. Roles may include director, stage manager, costume designer, props manager, sound operator, lighting assistant and publicity team. Safe staging includes clear exits, stable props and cables secured away from walkways.

- Read a short script and identify characters, setting, conflict and stage directions.
- Plan entrances, exits and stage positions.
- Use simple props that are safe and suitable.
- Rehearse transitions so the performance flows smoothly.
- Evaluate voice clarity, teamwork, timing and audience engagement.

16. Dance, choreography and movement composition

Dance is an organised use of body movement, often connected to rhythm, music, expression or cultural practice. Movement elements include body, action, space, time, energy and relationships. Choreography is the planned arrangement of movement into a sequence.

Movement can travel or remain in place; it can use different directions, pathways, levels, speeds and dynamics. Dancers should consider fitness, floor condition, footwear, hydration and personal space.

- Create a short movement phrase using three actions, such as turn, step and gesture.
- Repeat the phrase with a different level, direction or tempo.
- Work in groups to arrange a beginning, middle and ending.
- Use a safe warm-up and cool-down.
- Explain the idea or feeling communicated by the movement sequence.

17. Performance reflection and cultural respect

A performance is shaped by its context, audience, purpose and cultural setting. Learners should distinguish between learning about a tradition and claiming ownership of it. Some songs, dances, costumes or symbols may have restricted or sacred uses; seek guidance and permission.

Reflection helps performers improve. It should be specific: identify what happened, explain its effect and set a practical goal.

- Use appropriate names and descriptions for cultural material.
- Credit sources and acknowledge community knowledge holders where appropriate.
- Ask before photographing, recording or publishing a performance.
- Set one goal for voice, movement, timing or collaboration after each rehearsal.

PART D: SPORTS, PHYSICAL ACTIVITY AND HEALTHY LIVING

Sport and physical activity develop movement competence, fitness, teamwork, resilience, respect and healthy habits. The rules and skills taught should follow the activities selected by the school and the current Grade 9 curriculum design.

18. Physical fitness and safe participation

Physical fitness includes components such as cardiorespiratory endurance, muscular strength, muscular endurance, flexibility, speed, agility, balance and coordination. Different activities develop different components.

A warm-up prepares the body for activity through gradual movement and mobility. A cool-down allows activity to reduce gradually. Hydration, suitable clothing, safe equipment and adequate space reduce avoidable risk.

- Begin with light movement before more demanding activity.
- Use controlled technique rather than competing to lift, run or jump beyond ability.
- Stop and report pain, dizziness, breathing difficulty or unsafe conditions.
- Drink water and rest appropriately.
- Cool down and reflect on effort and recovery.

19. Fundamental movement skills

Locomotor skills move the body from one place to another: walking, running, hopping, jumping, skipping and dodging. Stability skills involve control without travelling: balancing, bending, stretching and twisting. Manipulative skills control objects: throwing, catching, kicking, striking, dribbling and rolling.

Skill development progresses from simple to complex. Practise correct body position, timing, control and awareness of others before adding speed or pressure.

- Practise throwing at a safe target using an appropriate object.
- Catch with eyes focused on the object and hands positioned to receive it.
- Practise dribbling while maintaining control and looking up.
- Use cones or markers to practise changes of direction without collisions.
- Give a partner one positive and one practical technique suggestion.

20. Teamwork, tactics and game understanding

A tactic is a planned action used to achieve an objective during a game. Tactics may include creating space, supporting a teammate, maintaining possession, defending an area or choosing when to pass or move.

Effective teamwork involves communication, shared responsibility, decision-making and respect. Players should understand the rules and the purpose of officials' decisions.

- Identify the objective and basic rules of the selected game before play.
- Practise passing and moving into open space.
- Use short-sided games to increase participation and decision-making.
- Discuss how a team can attack and defend safely.
- Rotate roles so learners experience different responsibilities.

21. Rules, officiating and fair play

Rules make a game organised and safer. Officials help apply rules consistently. Players should know the basic boundaries, scoring method, restarts and common infringements of the selected activity.

Fair play means honesty, respect, self-control and acceptance of decisions. It includes welcoming different abilities and ensuring all learners have meaningful opportunities to participate.

- Explain the purpose of key rules before playing.
- Practise making simple officiating decisions using agreed signals.
- Accept decisions calmly and ask questions respectfully at an appropriate time.
- Congratulate opponents and support teammates.
- Resolve disagreements through calm communication rather than aggression.

22. Personal fitness planning and reflection

A fitness plan should be realistic, progressive and appropriate to the learner. A useful goal is specific, measurable, achievable, relevant and time-bound. Progress can be recorded through repetitions, distance, time, perceived effort or skill consistency.

Do not compare learners' bodies or use exercise as punishment. The aim is personal improvement, enjoyment and lifelong participation.

- Set one personal goal, such as improving a controlled skill or completing regular activity.
- Record a baseline using a safe teacher-approved activity.
- Plan practice days, rest and gradual progression.
- Review progress and adjust the goal where necessary.
- Reflect on enjoyment, confidence, effort and safety.

23. Inclusion, wellbeing and injury prevention

Inclusive physical education adapts rules, equipment, space, roles or task difficulty so learners with different abilities can participate meaningfully. Adaptations should preserve the purpose of the activity while reducing unnecessary barriers.

Common prevention measures include checking the playing surface, using appropriate equipment, following instructions, avoiding dangerous contact and stopping when an injury is suspected. A learner should report an injury promptly and follow school first-aid procedures.

- Offer different distances, targets, equipment sizes or roles when needed.
- Use clear demonstrations and simple instructions.
- Do not force participation through pain or embarrassment.
- Report hazards and injuries immediately.
- Respect privacy and dignity when supporting an injured learner.

PART E: PRACTICAL PROJECTS AND PORTFOLIO

Project 1 – Visual communication poster

Choose a school or community theme such as water conservation, road safety or environmental care. Research the audience, draft three layouts, select a colour scheme, create a final poster and explain how the design communicates its message.

Project 2 – Repeating pattern or print

Develop an original motif from observed natural or geometric forms. Make a repeat pattern, test it at different scales and present a final design with a short process note.

Project 3 – Group music composition

Create an original short piece using voice, body percussion or approved instruments. Agree on a theme, build a rhythmic motif, arrange sections and perform for an audience.

Project 4 – Drama scene

In a group, devise a short scene about a constructive community issue. Assign production roles, rehearse, perform and complete a reflection on the message and teamwork.

Project 5 – Dance or movement sequence

Create a safe movement phrase with a clear beginning, development and ending. Use changes in direction, level, time and energy. Explain the intention and cultural context where relevant.

Project 6 – Personal activity plan

Select a suitable activity, set a realistic goal, plan safe practice, record progress and evaluate changes in skill, confidence and enjoyment.

Suggested assessment rubrics

Use the rubric as a guide and adapt it to the task. The teacher may use observation, learner explanation, peer feedback, portfolio evidence and performance.

Criterion	Emerging	Developing	Secure
Planning and preparation	Needs support to identify purpose or steps.	Identifies purpose and completes some planning.	Plans clearly and selects suitable materials or actions.
Technique and control	Uses limited control; frequent guidance needed.	Shows developing control with some consistency.	Uses appropriate technique with control and consistency.
Creativity and expression	Ideas are limited or unclear.	Communicates an idea with some originality.	Communicates a clear idea with thoughtful, original choices.
Collaboration and safety	Needs reminders about cooperation or safety.	Usually cooperates and follows key safety guidance.	Contributes reliably, respects others and applies safety practices.
Reflection and improvement	Gives limited reflection.	Identifies a strength or area to improve.	Uses specific evidence to evaluate and set a useful next step.

PART F: REVISION QUESTIONS

1. 1. Name four elements of art and explain how two can be used to create emphasis.

Suggested answer: Elements include line, shape, form, colour, texture, space and value. For example, a bright colour against muted colours or a thick dark line among fine lines can draw attention to a focal point.

2. 2. Distinguish between balance and contrast in a composition.

Suggested answer: Balance concerns the visual distribution of weight; contrast is the use of noticeable differences such as light/dark, large/small or warm/cool.

3. 3. Explain the difference between rhythm and melody in music.

Suggested answer: Rhythm organises sounds and silences in time; melody is a sequence of pitches forming a musical line.

4. 4. Give three ways a performer can communicate character without changing dialogue.

Suggested answer: Use posture, gesture, facial expression, movement, pace, pitch, tone or pauses.

5. 5. What is improvisation? State one rule that helps group improvisation succeed.

Suggested answer: Improvisation is spontaneous creation. Listening and accepting a partner's contribution helps a scene or musical exchange develop.

6. 6. Identify three components of a safe sports session.

Suggested answer: A suitable warm-up, inspected space/equipment, appropriate clothing, hydration, clear rules, supervision and cool-down are valid examples.

7. 7. Distinguish between locomotor and manipulative skills.

Suggested answer: Locomotor skills move the body through space, such as running and hopping. Manipulative skills control an object, such as throwing, catching or dribbling.

8. 8. State four features of fair play.

Suggested answer: Respect for rules, officials, opponents and teammates; honesty; self-control; inclusion; and acceptance of decisions.

9. 9. Describe how a learner can evaluate an artwork constructively.

Suggested answer: Describe visible features, analyse organisation, interpret possible meaning with evidence, evaluate effectiveness and suggest a respectful improvement.

10. 10. Why should cultural material be researched and credited?

Suggested answer: To represent it accurately and respectfully, acknowledge creators and knowledge holders, avoid misappropriation and respect restrictions or permissions.

Practical self-check

☐ Can I explain the elements and principles of art and use them in an original composition?

☐ Can I plan, make and evaluate a visual artwork using safe and appropriate materials?

☐ Can I identify rhythm, pulse, tempo, pitch, melody and dynamics in a listening example?

☐ Can I rehearse and perform with attention to timing, expression and ensemble cooperation?

☐ Can I use voice, movement and space to communicate a character or idea?

☐ Can I contribute to a drama, dance or movement composition and reflect on its impact?

☐ Can I demonstrate selected movement skills with control and safe technique?

☐ Can I explain basic rules, tactics, officiating and fair play in a selected sport?

☐ Can I set a realistic personal activity goal and record progress?

☐ Can I work inclusively and respect cultural knowledge, performers and classmates?

Safety and responsible participation

- Use scissors, blades, hot tools, adhesives, paints and other materials only under teacher direction and according to product instructions.

- Do not taste, inhale or apply art materials to the body. Wash hands after practical work.
- Keep floors, performance spaces and sports areas free of bags, loose cables and other trip hazards.
- Use instruments and sports equipment for their intended purpose; report damage.
- Warm up before vigorous activity and cool down afterwards. Stop if you feel unwell or injured.
- Obtain consent before recording, photographing or publishing another person's work or performance.
- Respect cultural protocols and copyright. Credit sources, composers, performers and artists.

Curriculum and editorial note

Prepared as original teacher-prepared learning support for Grade 9 Creative Arts and Sports. It is not an official KICD publication. The school should cross-check exact strand/sub-strand titles, required repertoire, selected sports, lesson counts and assessment expectations against the current KICD Grade 9 Creative Arts and Sports Curriculum Design and the school's approved scheme of work before classroom adoption.

Reference for curriculum verification: Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development (KICD), Grade 9 Creative Arts and Sports Curriculum Design (2024), available through the KICD curriculum designs portal.

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